OPEN SOURCE ENDOWMENT

Community call #1
13 May 2025

endowment.dev

Agenda

1. Intro
2. Roadmap (Konstantin)
3. Grant-making model (Chad)
4. Discussion

Intro

Board & ED

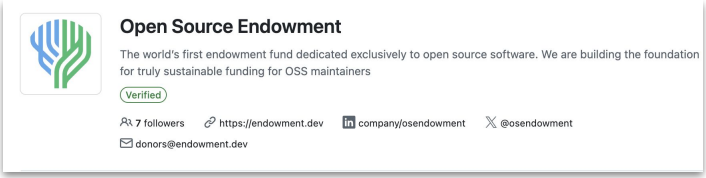
- Konstantin Vinogradov **(Board Director, Chairman)**
  General Partner, Runa Capital
- Chad Whitacre **(Board Director, Secretary)**
  Head of Open Source, Sentry; Leader, Open Source Pledge
- Maxim Konovalov **(Board Director, Treasurer)**
  Co-founder, Nginx; ex VP Engineering, F5 Networks
- Jonathan Starr **(Executive Director)**
  Program Manager, NumFOCUS; Founder, Institute of Open Science Practices

Advisors

- Amy Parker
  CFO, OpenSSL Foundation; ex Head, Wikimedia Endowment
- Vlad-Stefan Harbuz
  Independent researcher; Maintainer, Open Source Pledge

Members

- Co-founding donors with $1K+ commitments
- https://github.com/osendowment/foundation
  - Roadmap, grant-making model, other issues
  - All key docs of the Open Source Endowment
  - Only for the board, advisors and members
  - Plan to make the repo public ~ Q4 2025
- **Please provide you github login to KV, if it's not public**



Roadmap

Short-term plan

	Q1 2025	Q2 2025	Q3 2025	Q4 2025	Q1 2026
	Private phase			Public phase	
Governance	US nonprofit Bylaws & BoD Apply for 501(c)3	Members' repo Membership policy	Finalized BoD Finalized policies	501(c)3 approval* Open community	Donor conference
Grant-making		Draft grant model Select asset manager	Ready-to-publish model	Finalized model Basic model infra	Finalized model infra First invest. income First grants
Fundraising	First donors Bank wires Basic website	Card payments Donation platforms Landing page	Finalized co-founders Stock donations Non-USD donations Full website	Public repo 501(c)3 platforms Crypto donations	API for donations

https://github.com/osendowment/foundation/blob/main/roadmap.md

Roadmap

Governance

Target	Status
US nonprofit corporation	✅
Bylaws & key entity docs	✅
Initial board of directors	✅
501(c)3 charity status	⏳
Members' repo (private)	⏳
Membership policy	⏳
Other key policies	
Finalized board of directors	

Grant-making

Target	Status
MVP for data-driven donations	✅
Draft grant-making model	⏳
Select asset manager	⏳
Finalized grant-making model	
Implemented model infra	
First endowment fund income	
First model-based grants	

Fundraising

Target	Status
Co-founding donors	⏳
Bank wires (USD)	✅
Card payments	✅
Basic website	✅
Donation platforms	⏳
Landing page	⏳
Stock donations	
Fully functional website	
Public GitHub repo	
501(c)3 platforms	
Crypto donations	
Non-USD donations	
API-based donations	

https://github.com/osendowment/foundation/blob/main/roadmap.md

Model development

Timeline

1. Private development (Q2-Q3 2025)
2. Public development (Q4 2025)
3. First model-based grants (Q1 2026)
4. Impact monitoring (2026)
5. Learn & improve: back to step 2

Grant-making model for OSS maintenance

- Target: critical underfunded OSS
- Long-term impact, not fire-fighting
- Open measurable inputs and outputs
- Transparent verifiable methodology
- Lean efficient infrastructure
- Appropriate human-in-the-loop

https://github.com/osendowment/foundation/issues/2 **— your feedback is very welcome!**

Model dimensions

Target unit

- Individuals
- Projects
- Ecosystems
- Foundations

Funding unit

- Individuals
- Projects
- Foundations

Target ecosystems

- Python - XX% funds
- JS/TS - XX%…

https://github.com/osendowment/foundation/issues/2 **— your feedback is very welcome!**

Model dimensions

Sorting algo

- Score = f(Value, Risk)
- Value = f(downloads, dependencies, ...) = g(past performance, promise)
- Risk = f(active maintainers, known funding, ...)

Mode

- Reactive - collect applications, select the top N with highest scores (after checks)
- Proactive - outreach projects with highest scores, ask/check if they need grants

https://github.com/osendowment/foundation/issues/2 **— your feedback is very welcome!**

Model dimensions

Grant formats

- Usual grants ($5K+)
- Microgrants ($1-5K)
- Thin distribution (<$1K)

Infra

- Direct money transfers
- Ecosyste.ms Funds
- thanks.dev
- GitHub Sponsors

https://github.com/osendowment/foundation/issues/2 — your feedback is very welcome!

Hypothetical Model Examples

	Model 1 (“Microgrant Org”)	Model 2 (“Spray & Pray”)
Selection unit	OSS project	OSS project
Funding unit	OSS project	GitHub user, Collective, etc. (depends on infra)
Ecosystems	40% Python, 40% JavaScript/TypeScript, 20% Rust (start)	
Sorting algo	Similar to KV’s PyPI test for projects, but for 3 ecosystems.	
Mode	Reactive (“submit an application”)	Proactive (“take our money”)
Grant format	$4K microgrants	$1-1000 per funding unit
Infra	Endowment.dev + direct wire transfers	GitHub Sponsors, OpenCollective, etc.
Reporting	GitHub + Endowment.dev + check-in calls	GitHub

https://github.com/osendowment/foundation/issues/2 — your feedback is very welcome!

Hypothetical Model Examples

	Model 3 (“Foundation of Foundations”)
Selection unit	Ecosystem
Funding unit	Foundation (manually approved subset, 80+ eligible foundations)
Ecosystems	Our decision or take-what-you-want (each foundation sets their own take, takes and total available are public)
Sorting algo	LIFO distribution, OSE mediates conflicts
Mode	Reactive (“submit an application”)
Grant format	Usual grants
Infra	Endowment.dev + direct transfers
Reporting	Each foundation provides distribution to individuals (% Product / GTM / Ops) an distribution mechanism / algorithm

https://github.com/osendowment/foundation/issues/2 — your feedback is very welcome!

Let’s discuss!

Model

- Preferred dimensions or examples?
- Specific situations to pursue / avoid?

Other questions

- Preferred ways to communication
- Inputs for the investment strategy